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EVIDENCE-BASED CHECKLIST · LONGEVITY

What actually lowers your biological age

8 habits with proven effects on lifespan and healthspan — and how many years each one moves the needle.

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8 habits that lower biological age

The “up to N years” figures are the potential gap between the worst and best option in large cohort studies. They are the same weights used in our biological age calculator.

- [ ] **Don’t smoke — and if you do, quit** — up to 7 yrs
  Quitting gives back almost everything, especially before 40.
  Jha, NEJM 2013

- [ ] **Move: 150 minutes a week** — up to 4.5 yrs
  ≈22.5 MET-hours — brisk walking, cycling, swimming.
  Moore, PLoS Med 2012

- [ ] **Keep weight in a healthy range** — up to 8 yrs
  BMI 18.5–25; waist < 94 cm (men) / 80 cm (women).
  PSC, Lancet 2009

- [ ] **Keep alcohol to a minimum** — up to 4.5 yrs
  Less is better; aim for < 100 g pure alcohol per week.
  Wood, Lancet 2018

- [ ] **Eat whole food, less ultra-processed** — up to 3 yrs
  Vegetables, legumes, whole grains, nuts, fish.
  Fadnes, 2022

- [ ] **Sleep 7–8 hours** — up to 1.5 yrs
  Both too little and too much sleep shorten life.
  Cappuccio, Sleep 2010

- [ ] **Keep blood pressure ≤ 120/80** — up to 4 yrs
  Check regularly; every +20 mmHg doubles the risk.
  PSC, Lancet 2002

- [ ] **Keep strong social connections** — up to 3.5 yrs
  Real-life connection is a survival factor, not a luxury.
  Holt-Lunstad, 2010

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Where to start this week

1. **Pick one habit**
   The one with the biggest gap for you. Changing everything at once is the surest way to quit.

2. **Schedule 3 walks of 30 minutes**
   On specific days. Movement is the fastest lever after quitting smoking.

3. **Go to bed 30 minutes earlier**
   Three nights in a row. Sleep repairs appetite, blood pressure and mood at once.

Find out your biological age in 2 minutes

24zdorovie.com/en/tools/biological-age-calculator/

Sources

Jha P. et al. 21st-century hazards of smoking. NEJM 2013.

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Educational material, not a substitute for medical advice. Make health decisions together with a professional.

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